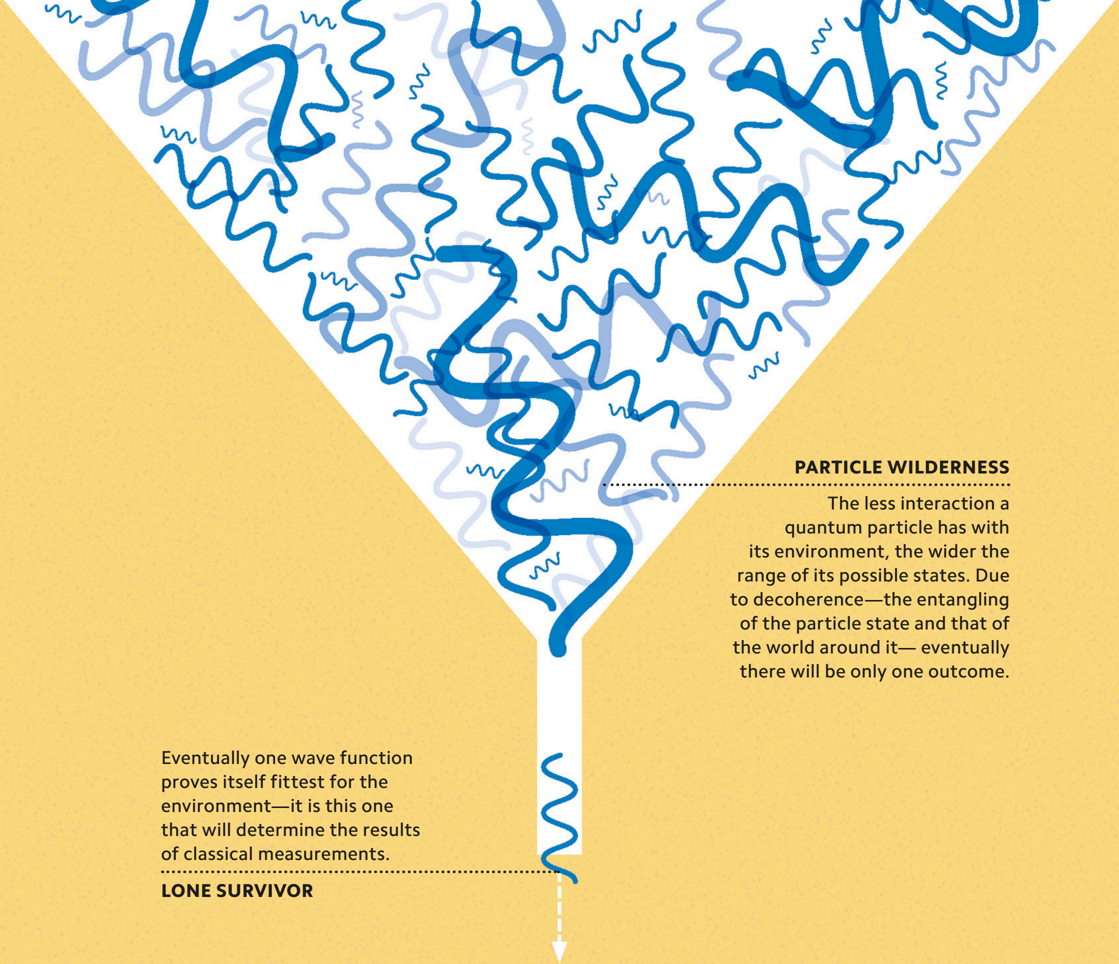

SURVIVAL OF THE FITTEST

If hidden variables (see pp.56–57) do not guide the wave function to collapse into a certain state, perhaps something else does? Quantum Darwinism, as its name suggests, involves an idea similar to Charles Darwin's evolutionary "survival of the fittest." According to this interpretation, interactions between a particle and factors in its environment gradually filter the possible end states of its wave function until it settles on a single outcome known as a "pointer state."